



New Food Innovation

PLANT-BASED CHEESE

Coconut Cheddar v3

NFI COMMERCIAL DECISION REPORT

GO

SENSORY DECISION



DIRECTIONAL CONCEPT VISUAL

DECISION SNAPSHOT

PRODUCT DECISION: GO

01

READINESS STAGE

Approved for launch preparation · claims evidence limited

NFI VIEW · WHAT THE DECISION MEANS

The product clears the sensory decision gate and can proceed into launch preparation. Concept evidence is directional only and should not be used for demand, preference, purchase-intent, price, or final packaging claims.

ISSF SCORE

82.4

EVIDENCE STRENGTH

86/100

CONCEPT EVIDENCE

n=24 · directional only

CORE STRENGTH

Overall sensory acceptance (84/100) is the strongest documented sensory result.

MAIN WATCH POINT

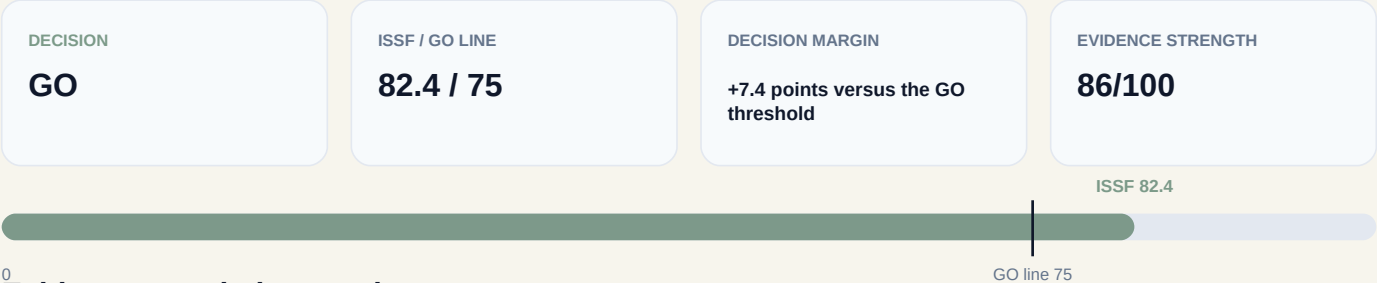
Concept evidence is directional only; consumer and market claims require broader validation.

NFI VIEW · RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION

Proceed with launch preparation. Confirm pilot-scale product performance, then build the claim-ready launch story through target-consumer validation, packaging approval, and claims/legal review.

The product clears the GO threshold and all critical product gates

Why the decision was reached, how strong the evidence is, and which changes would require a new review.



Evidence populations and provenance



NFI VIEW · WHAT THIS MEANS

The product has cleared the internal product decision gate. The next question is not whether the tested sample can advance; it is whether the formula, packaging, claims, and commercial case can be validated for release.

Decision gates

What would change the decision

● Off-note control · PASS

No material off-note gate remains open.

● Instrument quality control · PASS

Instrument recovery is inside the method range.

- The current score is 7.4 points above the GO threshold.

- Texture performance is the nearest sensory constraint at 68/100, 8 points above the readiness line.

- A critical product-gate failure, invalid evidence, ISSF below 75, or a required dimension below 60 would require a new decision review.

- MATERIAL LIMITATIONS
- This report includes reference/demo evidence and is not eligible for external approval.
 - Consumer preference and purchase-intent are unvalidated.
 - Texture performance is below the 60/100 readiness line.
 - No external sensory, nutrition, or benefit claims are approved.

MANAGEMENT DECISION · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

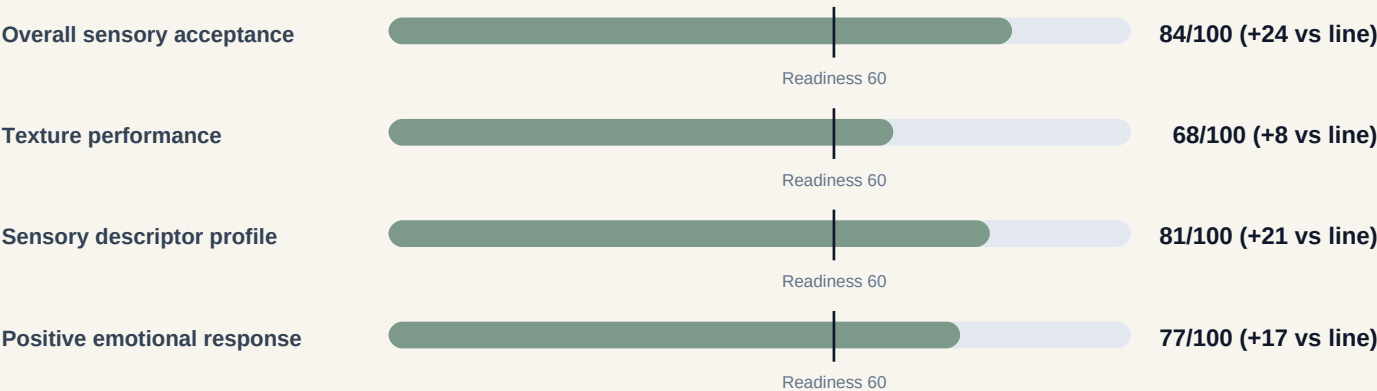
Authorize controlled launch preparation and the named validation work. Do not authorize consumer, demand, price, packaging-preference, nutrition, health, or superiority claims at this stage.

All four sensory dimensions clear the readiness line

03

Measured sensory performance, study basis, benchmark context, and the implications to protect through scale-up.

Dimension performance



OVERALL SENSORY ACCEPTANCE

Sensory panel n=14 · Overall liking 7.6/9, Flavour 7.6/9

Trained-panel reference 86/100

Acceptance supports moving the product into the next validation round.

TEXTURE PERFORMANCE

Sensory panel n=14 · Creamy 8.4/10, Smooth 8.6/10

Category readiness line 60/100

Texture is viable but should be monitored through scale-up.

SENSORY DESCRIPTOR PROFILE

Sensory panel n=14 · Cheese 13/14 (93%), Butter 12/14 (86%)

Category-positive descriptor target

The sensory profile is recognizable and category-relevant.

POSITIVE EMOTIONAL RESPONSE INDICATORS

Sensory panel n=14 · Positive 4.4/5, Negative 0.8/5

Net emotional valence +3.6

Positive response supports the direction, but remains secondary evidence.

NFI VIEW · WHAT THE EVIDENCE SUPPORTS

The product cleared the internal sensory screen. Acceptance, texture, descriptor fit, and emotional response support launch preparation and pilot-scale confirmation.

WHAT IS NOT YET PROVEN

Concept response is n=24. Do not treat purchase intent, price feedback, packaging preference, or concept descriptors as representative market evidence.

Study basis: Sensory panel n=14; concept test n=0. Scores are shown on a 0–100 scale. Evidence caveat: variability and agreement statistics were not included in this report snapshot and should be added to the next validation round.

Instrumental evidence supports the decision and directs the next controls

Project measurements show whether the sensory result is technically coherent; literature is used beside the evidence to shape the next validation method.

INSTRUMENTAL STATUS · INCLUDED

Instrumental findings were included in the deterministic decision context.

SUPPORTS

E-tongue / composition model

Instrument signal 72.3/100 from taste and composition inputs

Benchmark: Production ISSF instrument-signal transform

SUPPORTS

GC-MS / GC-O

2 aroma findings; no critical off-note gate failure

Benchmark: Off-note decision gate

SUPPORTS

Internal-standard QC

Recovery 95.1%

1 replicate · repeatability not established

Benchmark: Pass range 85–110%

Technical and execution risks

PRODUCT RISK · NEXT GATE PILOT VALIDATION

Reduce late-stage gumminess and confirm melt performance after pilot-scale processing.

Impact: A changed or inconsistent product experience could invalidate the current sensory screening outcome.

Control: Set pilot-scale acceptance ranges and repeat the critical sensory measures.

CONCEPT/PACKAGING RISK · NEXT GATE DESIGN REVIEW

Directional packaging may be mistaken for a finished pack.

Impact: Buyer feedback may focus on unfinished design choices instead of the product proposition.

Control: Label the stimulus as directional and complete design refinement before external use.

NFI view · Scientific guidance applied to the next study

[L1] Texture and mouthfeel confirmation

Keep texture and mouthfeel measures in the pilot confirmation plan because structure strongly shapes the plant-based cheese experience.

[L2] Target-consumer validation

Benchmark the correct product format and confirm positioning and usage cues with the intended consumer group.

VERIFIED SOURCES:

[L1] Texture drivers in plant-based cheese alternatives, study type not captured

[L2] Consumer acceptance of plant-based foods, category study

Product readiness: sensory GO, production release pending

Product readiness separates the validated product evidence from the technical work still required for a repeatable, compliant launch product.

Sensory performance CURRENT EVIDENCE ISSF 82.4; sensory panel n=14.	DECISION IMPACT Supports controlled launch preparation for the tested product.	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE Repeat the critical sensory measures on the pilot-scale product.	READY
Instrumental confirmation CURRENT EVIDENCE 3 decision findings recorded.	DECISION IMPACT Supports the current product decision.	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE Repeat against pilot-scale specifications and QC ranges.	READY
Pilot manufacturing CURRENT EVIDENCE No validated pilot-batch or process-capability record is included.	DECISION IMPACT Scale-up could change texture, flavour, yield, or batch consistency.	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE Pilot batch record, process window, yield, variability, and release specifications.	PENDING
Shelf life and food safety CURRENT EVIDENCE No representative packed-batch shelf-life study or signed food-safety review is attached.	DECISION IMPACT A use-by or best-before period, storage conditions, and product release cannot yet be authorized.	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE Representative packed-batch timepoints through the proposed end date: HACCP-defined microbiology, chemical and physical stability, and blinded sensory acceptability under planned storage.	EVIDENCE GAP
Packaging compatibility CURRENT EVIDENCE A directional visual exists; technical pack performance is untested.	DECISION IMPACT Seal integrity, product protection, fill performance, and chilled-life compatibility remain unknown.	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE Pack specification, line trial, seal/leak testing, compatibility, and transport validation.	IN PROGRESS
Regulatory, labeling, and nutrition CURRENT EVIDENCE No signed ingredient, allergen, nutrition, naming, label, or claims review is included.	DECISION IMPACT Final label copy and nutrition or benefit claims cannot be released.	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE Approved ingredient list, allergen assessment, nutrition panel, legal name, and label review.	PENDING

NFI VIEW · PRODUCT READINESS CONCLUSION The tested product is ready for controlled launch preparation. Production release still requires pilot reproducibility, shelf-life and safety evidence, packaging validation, and regulatory approval.
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The proposition is defined; market proof and economics remain open

The working consumer proposition is clear enough to test, while the evidence required for pricing, demand, channel, and investment decisions remains incomplete.

WORKING PROPOSITION

Everyday Melt

For flexitarian shoppers seeking a familiar plant-based cheddar for everyday cooking, Coconut Cheddar v3.0 proposes recognizable cheddar-category cues in a coconut-based format.

PRIORITY CONSUMER

Flexitarian households seeking an easy dairy swap without sacrificing familiar flavor

PROMISE

Hypothesis: a dairy-free cheddar alternative that feels familiar and practical in cooked meals.

PRICE HYPOTHESIS

Test \$5.99 per 7 oz pack against category alternatives.

COMMERCIAL EVIDENCE COVERAGE



DIRECTIONAL CONCEPT VISUAL · CONCEPT EVIDENCE
BOUNDARY N=24

0 ready · 2 active · 5 evidence gaps



● In progress 2 ● Evidence gap 4 ● Requires validation 1

	CURRENT EVIDENCE	REQUIRED NEXT EVIDENCE
● Positioning and proposition IN PROGRESS	A product-specific positioning, target consumer, promise, and usage hypothesis are defined.	Confirm clarity, relevance, distinctiveness, and priority occasion with target consumers.
● Target-consumer validation REQUIRES VALIDATION	Concept test n=24; insufficient for representative interpretation.	Powered target-consumer study with documented panel fit, stimuli, measures, and analysis plan.
● Competitive benchmark EVIDENCE GAP	Named products, price points, pack formats, and sensory benchmarks are not included.	Select direct alternatives and compare sensory performance, proposition, price, pack, and claims.
● Price architecture IN PROGRESS	Working price hypothesis: \$5.99 per 7 oz pack.	Test price, pack size, value perception, and willingness to buy against category alternatives.
● Unit economics EVIDENCE GAP	COGS, yield, packaging cost, logistics, trade terms, margin, and investment are not captured.	Costed bill of materials, conversion cost, landed cost, target margin, trade spend, and launch budget.
● Channel and buyer strategy EVIDENCE GAP	Priority channel, buyer requirements, distribution model, and launch account are not documented.	Select priority channel and accounts; document buyer criteria, distribution, merchandising, and launch timing.
● Demand and launch forecast EVIDENCE GAP	No representative demand evidence, rate-of-sale assumption, or volume forecast is included.	Build scenarios from validated demand inputs, distribution assumptions, rate of sale, repeat, and capacity.

NFI VIEW · COMMERCIAL CONCLUSION

Commercial development can continue, but investment approval requires a validated consumer case, competitive and price evidence, unit economics, a defined channel, and a documented launch forecast.

REFERENCE / DEMONSTRATION EVIDENCE — NOT APPROVED FOR EXTERNAL USE

Three workstreams convert product GO into launch readiness

Three programs close the remaining product, commercial, packaging, regulatory, and approval gaps.

1

Pilot manufacturing, product confirmation, and shelf life

WHY THIS WORK	PROTOCOL	PASS / NEXT GATE
Confirm safety, repeatability, and sensory consistency after scale-up.	Run representative packed pilot batches under planned storage; repeat critical sensory and instrumental measures; test HACCP-defined microbiology, physical stability, and blinded sensory acceptability through the proposed end date. Evidence: Approved pilot, QC timepoints, and shelf-life report.	Safety and agreed sensory/quality criteria pass through proposed life. n>=18 is the operational sensory minimum; power the final study to its objective. Next gate: Pilot validation.
Owner: To assign	Timing: Next pilot cycle	Budget: To scope before approval
IF NOT MET Hold release, correct the failure, and repeat the affected validation.		

2

Consumer, competition, price, and commercial economics

WHY THIS WORK	PROTOCOL	PASS / NEXT GATE
Market proof and economics remain unvalidated.	Run a powered target-consumer study; benchmark alternatives; test proposition and price; model product, pack, logistics, margin, trade spend, and launch investment. Evidence: Consumer dataset, benchmark, price architecture, and approved economics model.	Concept n>=30 with documented panel fit; approved benchmark, price, margin, and launch scenarios is the minimum directional concept read. If the study will support demand forecasting, pricing, or investment decisions, power the sample size to that objective. Next gate: Investment review.
Owner: To assign	Timing: Before buyer review	Budget: To scope before approval
IF NOT MET Revise the proposition, price, economics, or channel and repeat the failed gate.		

3

Packaging, regulatory, claims, and launch approval

WHY THIS WORK	PROTOCOL	PASS / NEXT GATE
The final pack and external statements require approval.	Validate pack and line performance; approve ingredients, allergens, nutrition, naming, labeling, and claims; complete launch review. Evidence: Approved pack, line trial, label, claims matrix, and launch record.	Pack tests pass; regulatory, legal, quality, and commercial approve release. Next gate: Launch approval.
Owner: To assign	Timing: Before external release	Budget: To scope before approval
IF NOT MET Do not release the affected element until corrected and approved.		

NFI VIEW · NEXT DECISION GATE

Move from launch preparation to launch execution only after pilot and shelf-life approval, commercial investment review, and packaging/regulatory launch approval.

Two claims are supported; four remain unavailable for release

Client-safe summary: The product may be described as approved for launch preparation based on the tested sensory screen. Consumer preference, demand, price, packaging preference, nutrition, health, or superiority claims are not available until validated and approved.

SUPPORTED	Product advancement decision	INTERNAL DECISION STATEMENT
EVIDENCE GO at ISSF 82.4; Sensory panel n=14.	PERMITTED WORDING Approved to proceed into launch preparation.	REQUIREMENT Limited to the tested product and study conditions.
SUPPORTED	Tested sensory results	INTERNAL DECISION STATEMENT
EVIDENCE Acceptance 84/100; texture 68/100.	PERMITTED WORDING Report the measured results with sample size and study basis.	REQUIREMENT Repeat at pilot scale before production-performance claims.
BLOCKED	Consumer preference or demand	EXTERNAL CLAIM
EVIDENCE Concept test n=24.	PERMITTED WORDING No external preference or demand wording.	REQUIREMENT Complete target-consumer validation at n>=30 with documented panel fit.
BLOCKED	Price acceptance and purchase intent	EXTERNAL CLAIM
EVIDENCE Purchase-intent observations exist at n=24; price representativeness is not established.	PERMITTED WORDING No external price or purchase-intent wording.	REQUIREMENT Complete target-consumer validation at n>=30 with documented panel fit.
BLOCKED	Packaging preference	EXTERNAL CLAIM
EVIDENCE The selected visual is a directional concept stimulus, not approved final artwork.	PERMITTED WORDING Directional packaging hypothesis for research use only.	REQUIREMENT Complete packaging validation, design approval, and legal review.
BLOCKED	Nutrition, health, or superiority benefits	EXTERNAL CLAIM
EVIDENCE No claim-specific substantiation is included in this report.	PERMITTED WORDING None until substantiated and approved.	REQUIREMENT Create a claim-specific evidence file and obtain legal approval.

NFI RELEASE VIEW · REPORT STATUS · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

External distribution is pending report approval. No external marketing claim is authorized until its specific evidence and approval requirement is complete.